

10 Thanksgiving Party Must-Haves

By: Chaz Wilke - Staff Writer



Cornucopia

This horn-shaped wicker basket filled with seasonal fruit and vegetables (pictured above) is an absolute Thanksgiving necessity. Be sure to have one as your centerpiece before you invite people over to your home for Thanksgiving dinner.

Squash



Fall is the season of squash. These gourds taste great roasted, grilled, sautéed or deep-fried, and are aesthetically fitting for your Thanksgiving decorations.

(<https://solarmehome.com/?cid=28806>)

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Jellied Cranberry Sauce



[Photograph: [Robert S. Donovan on Flickr](#) ("") - cropped from original]

Cranberries are disgusting in their natural form. But don't take my word for it. Ocean Spray, the leading purveyor of the small crimson fruit, recently sent a letter to the FDA describing the natural disgusting taste of the cranberry. "Yet, cranberries (unlike grapes, apples and oranges) are naturally low in sugar, giving them a distinctively tart, astringent and even unpalatable taste (<http://1.usa.gov/1pWNYaY>)," the letter reads.

Luckily, science has designed a better version of this berry abomination. Stock up on the superior gelatinous canned version of cranberries. Extra points if you present it as a can-shaped obelisk of cranberry goo. Delicious!

Mountains of Mash



Fun fact: Thanksgiving and mashed potatoes roomed together in college. True story. Mashed potato mounds will customarily appear on just about all of your guests' Thanksgiving dinner plates. This starch dish functions both as an edible reservoir of delicious gravy as well as a natural food divider (keep those string beans far away from that turkey!). Mashed potatoes are a must at any fall gathering. Stock up!

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Seasonal Thank You Cards



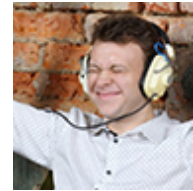
There are thank you cards, and then there are thank you cards (<http://bit.ly/1znreAV>). If you really want your guests to feel thanked, be sure to send a seasonally appropriate card of thanks.

Paper Towel Trays for Guest Bathroom



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When visiting someone else's place, I'm sure I'm not the only one who has a small panic attack when a bath towel is all that's available to dry my hands in the bathroom. Provide sanitary single-use disposable paper towels. There are countless seasonally-appropriate options to choose from.

Drink Identifiers



Prevent another guest panic attack by providing them with a personal drink identification system. There are plenty to choose from depending on your preferred libations. Wine glasses: [charms](http://amzn.to/112U8KB) (<http://amzn.to/112U8KB>). Beer: [koozies](http://amzn.to/1EHRTLTV). Solo cups: [permanent marker](http://amzn.to/1xTsURL) (<http://amzn.to/1xTsURL>). Your guests will thank you.

A Football



There will likely be a group of guests who just aren't into helping prepare the meal. Unless you live in a palatial mansion, you don't want everybody hovering in the kitchen anyway. Provide a football or some outdoor game for guests to play before you serve your meal.

A Collection of Kids Movies



Hell hath no fury like a child bored. Be sure to stock up on kids movies to keep the little ones entertained before and after mealtime. A few Thanksgiving appropriate kids movies include: "Addams Family Reunion," "Free Birds," "A Charlie Brown Thanksgiving" and "Pocahontas."

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